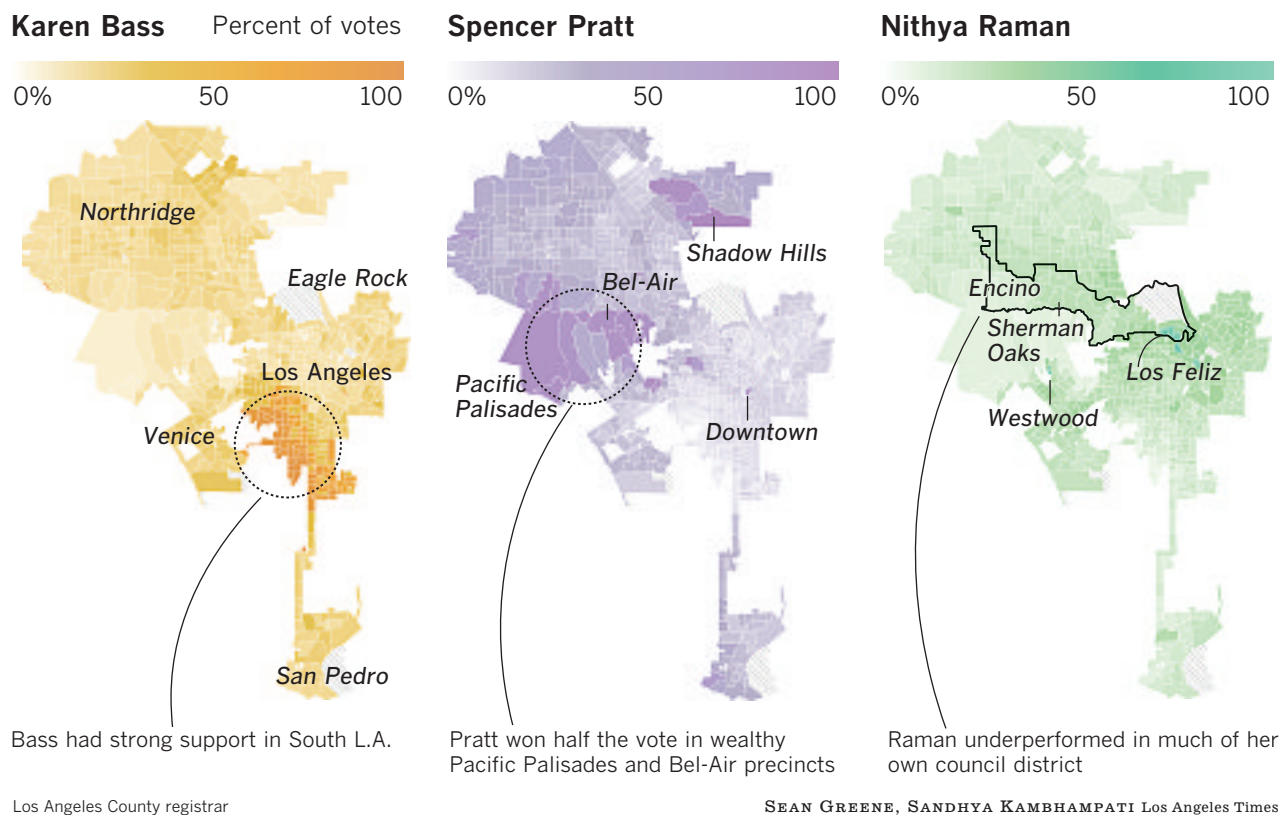


Where the mayoral candidates’ support comes from

Results are preliminary, with 62% of expected votes in as of June 3.



Judge rejects Trump asylum policy

Scathing ruling also affects work permits, green cards for people from 39 nations.

By MICHAEL CASEY

BOSTON — A federal judge on Friday struck down a Trump administration policy enacted after the shooting of two National Guard members that made it harder for immigrants from dozens of countries to stay in and enter the U.S. by asylum and other means.

In a ruling harshly criticizing the administration, U.S. District Chief Judge John McConnell Jr. said the policy “threw the lives of countless immigrants living in the United States into indeterminate legal limbo,” and he accused the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services of ignoring the law.

“In enacting its latest immigration policies, USCIS: claims statutory and regulatory authority that it does not possess; makes decisions without the reasoned explanations that it must provide; acts without regard for the reliance interests of applicants that it must consider; and justifies its actions with pretextual concerns of ‘national security’ that mask anti-immigrant sentiments that it is forbidden from letting influence its decision-making,” he wrote. “In legal terms that means USCIS’s actions are contrary to law and arbitrary and capricious.”

A spokesperson for the Department of Homeland Security did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

The policies enacted after the National Guard shooting last year meant immigrants from 39 African, Asian, Latin American and Middle Eastern countries have been “categorically barred” from receiving final decisions on, among other things, their asylum, work permit, green card and citizenship applications.

The ruling forces the federal government to reinstate regular processing and to work through thousands of backlogged cases. It represents a significant setback for the administration, which has worked simultaneously to counter illegal immigration while cutting [See Ruling, A8]

L.A. area begins year with its worst smog in decades

Early heat waves led to more ozone, air agency says

By TONY BRISCOE

The first five months of 2026 in Southern California have been the smoggiest — with the highest number of unhealthy air days — in more than a decade, according to statewide air monitoring.

So far this year, the South Coast air basin, which includes Los Angeles, Orange, Riverside and San Bernardino counties, has seen 39 days when the concentration of lung-irritating ozone (commonly known as smog) exceeded the federal standard, according to preliminary state air quality data.

That’s even worse than the infamously hot and hazy 2017, when Greater Los Angeles had 36 unhealthy air days by June 4 and ultimately saw 145.

Many of the roughly 18 million people who live in the

air basin have been subjected to unhealthy levels of ozone, a highly corrosive gas that triggers asthma attacks and a wide range of respiratory illnesses. This has taken many by surprise since successive days of smog more commonly happen in summer, when heat waves and intense sunlight convert man-made pollution into ozone.

“If we have this many violations by this time, this could be a really awful year for air quality,” said Adrian Martinez, director of Earthjustice’s Right to Zero campaign, an initiative calling for the transition from fossil fuels. “We’re already the worst place in the country for summertime smog pollution. So it could be one of the worst years in one of the worst places in the country.”

The pollution has been especially severe in valleys. On April 18, an air monitor in

Reseda in the San Fernando Valley measured the second highest spike in hourly ozone levels in the past decade.

The South Coast Air Quality Management District says the high ozone levels are due to early heat waves. Officials said they were not aware of any increase in the pollutants — most of them from different kinds of exhaust — that lead to ozone formation.

Local temperatures have been well above normal, climbing into the mid-80s and high 90s between January and April, breaking several daily high temperature records, according to the National Weather Service.

March in particular was the warmest on record in California. Riverside had an unprecedented 13 days of temperatures above 90 degrees, the weather service [See Smog, A6]



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

FOSSILIZED dire wolf skulls are displayed at the La Brea Tar Pits. Millions of fragile, irreplaceable items are being packed away for the impending renovation.

Evolution of Tar Pits is underway as the museum readies for closure

By CORINNE PURTILL

The back rooms of the La Brea Tar Pits are, at the moment, a maze of packing crates tagged with handwritten sticky notes that say things like “bison skulls” or “camel hip.”

Every bone, down to the last dire wolf rib, must be carefully sheathed in a custom foam shell. Sloth jaws and sabertooth fangs and a truly astonishing amount of ancient vertebrae — all of it will be swaddled, catalogued

and crated for the next two years.

On July 6, the La Brea Tar Pits will close its doors for a massive renovation. When it reopens in summer 2028, the remodeled Hancock Park museum will be the centerpiece of the Samuel Oschin Global Center for Ice Age Research, a scientific hub dedicated to an era of natural history better preserved here than anywhere else on Earth.

The new grounds, which will largely hew to the current building’s footprint, will

better show off the museum’s collection and explain how much the ecosystem preserved in the pits can tell us about where our current one is heading.

But first, somebody has to pack it all up — all 3.5 million fossils, each fragile and irreplaceable, like a house move out of a nightmare.

The same bounty that makes the Tar Pits the best place on Earth to study its slice of the late Pleistocene epoch also makes for a move of truly mammoth proportion [See Tar Pits, A8]

Bass, Pratt and Raman all have their own turf

Mapping out how mayoral candidates dominate in distinct L.A. neighborhoods.

By NOAH GOLDBERG, SANDHYA KAMBHAMPATI AND SEAN GREENE

Mayor Karen Bass ran the table in South Los Angeles, Spencer Pratt found strong support from his Westside base, and Nithya Raman racked up votes in Echo Park and other neighborhoods with a concentration of renters, according to a Times analysis of partial precinct-level results from this week’s primary election.

The Times analysis, based on an estimated 62% of the ballots counted so far, found that Pratt was favored in many of the same neighborhoods that voted for mayoral candidate Rick Caruso in 2022, while Raman made inroads in progressive areas dominated by Bass four years ago.

Bass found support in

neighborhoods along much of the Harbor and Santa Monica freeway corridors, along with central San Fernando Valley communities from Van Nuys to Arleta.

With much of the vote left to be counted, a map prepared by The Times showing how neighborhoods voted represents a snapshot of an election still very much underway. Bass garnered enough votes on election night to qualify for a Nov. 3 runoff, the Associated Press determined, but votes are still being tallied and it’s not yet clear if she will face Pratt or Raman.

Early returns show Pratt with a significant lead over Raman, but some analysts expect the remaining ballots to lean Democratic, as many left-of-center voters held on to their mail-in ballots until the last minute as they waited to choose between Democratic gubernatorial candidates.

Not surprisingly, Pratt did well in the Pacific Palisades, where his home burned down in the 2025 fire, [See Mayor, A6]

Becerra heads to governor runoff

The Democrat is a step closer to being the first elected Latino leader of state.

By NICOLE NIXON

Veteran Democratic politician Xavier Becerra won one of the top two spots in California’s primary election for governor, according to the Associated Press, a finish that puts him in a prime position to win in November and make history as California’s first elected Latino governor.

“The people of the great state of California, in the greatest nation on earth, have spoken — loudly and proudly,” Xavier Becerra said in a statement Friday. “We will not be bought. We will not be bullied. And we are never backing down. November, here we come.”



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

AS OF now, it appears Becerra will face Steve Hilton in November.

Former Fox News host Steve Hilton, a Republican, remains in a close second and appears on the cusp of securing the right to face off with Becerra in the November general election.

Tom Steyer, a hedge fund manager turned climate change activist, may be destined to finish in third place — which would be a disappointment [See Becerra, A6]

World Cup is at risk from climate change

Rising heat, humidity could make the 2026 tournament one of the last held in summer.

By KEVIN BAXTER

A few hours after Lionel Messi and the Argentine World Cup team checked into their training base in Kansas City, Kan., a series of thunderstorms pounded the area, knocking out power, felling trees and bringing flood and tornado warnings.

Hardly ideal conditions for the world’s biggest soccer tournament.

Yet that’s likely just the opening salvo of a disruptive weather system that could affect the 38-day competition, which kicks off next week with games in Mexico, Canada and the U.S.

“It’s pretty safe to say climate change is going to have a mark on this World Cup,”

said Kaitlyn Trudeau, a senior research associate of climate science for Sacramento-based Climate Central. “With climate change we know it’s not just going to be hotter, but it’s also going to increase the humidity as well.”

And that could make this summer’s World Cup one of the last of its kind. Tournament soccer in June and July has been a tradition dating to the first World Cup in 1930, but since then global temperatures in June have warmed by 1.89 degrees, according to the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration. That may not sound like a lot, but it takes many days and nights of extreme heat to move the needle that much.

“It can be a very dangerous situation,” Trudeau said.

As a result, FIFA president Gianni Infantino has already begun discussions [See World Cup, A11]

\$70 billion to aid deportations

Republican-controlled Senate approves cash infusion for Homeland Security. **NATION, A3**

Troop reversals may cost millions

Defense officials say Trump’s abrupt decisions are causing uncertainty. **WORLD, A2**

Character actor is fatally stabbed

Police arrest suspect in killing of James Handy, 81, after bizarre 911 call. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

State eclipsed in Fortune 500 list

Though Texas ranked higher, California still “dominates” on most measures. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 78/62. **B8**

Markets

Opinion Voices **A11**

Opinion Voices **A13**

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